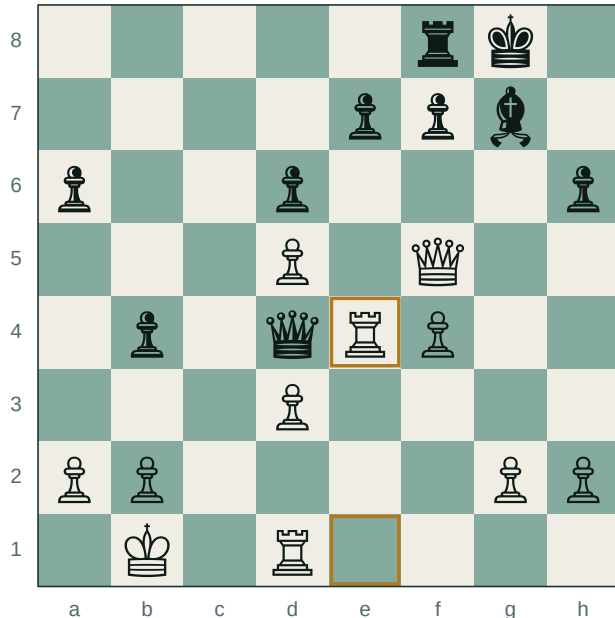


# Queenside attacks: Black, move 22

Queenside attacks

Black to move



Previous move: 22.Re4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**22...Qxb2#**

**22...Qxb2#** Mate: queen on b2 gives check; White has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on b1. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

**CHECKPOINT**

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Queen on b2. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

The board's left half is not inherently safe. Queen checks and rook entries can make a queenside king as vulnerable as a kingside one.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

An attack on the queenside can target a castled king, a vulnerable pawn, or trapped pieces. Files and entry squares matter more than simply advancing flank pawns.

**HOW TO LOOK**

Locate the critical target and which pawn or piece move opens a route toward it. Check whether central counterplay interrupts the plan.

The defending king is on b1. Geometrically undefended: queen on f5 and rook on d1. Check for tactical protection.